

Equipment Cleaning & Release SOP

Illustrative GMP procedure showing responsibilities, controlled cleaning steps, release criteria and records.

Document ID	PQ-DEMO-SOP-001
Version	01
Discipline	GMP procedure
Deliverable type	Standard operating procedure
Status	Fictional demonstration sample
Prepared for	Public ProcessQuill portfolio

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1. Purpose

To define a clear, controlled method for cleaning and releasing a fictional product-contact mixing vessel after manufacture. This sample demonstrates SOP structure and wording only; it is not an approved cleaning instruction.

2. Scope

Applies to the example vessel, associated removable product-contact parts and the documented release of the equipment for the next intended use. Cleaning validation requirements are referenced but not replaced by this SOP.

3. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Production operator	Perform cleaning steps, identify equipment status and complete the cleaning record.
Production supervisor	Verify completion, review documentation and resolve obvious discrepancies.
Quality / authorized reviewer	Review deviations where required and approve exceptional release decisions.
Engineering / maintenance	Support technical defects; ensure maintenance activity is documented before release.

4. Safety and prerequisites

- Confirm equipment is in a safe state and isolated as required by site procedures.
- Wear the defined PPE.
- Confirm the previous product / batch is identified in the cleaning record.
- Confirm only approved cleaning agent and water quality are available.
- Do not begin cleaning if a technical defect could compromise safe execution.

5. Procedure

Step	Activity	Instruction
5.1	Remove gross residue	Drain remaining process material according to the approved disposal/recovery instruction.
5.2	Pre-rinse	Rinse product-contact surfaces using the defined water quality until visible residue is removed.
5.3	Detergent cleaning	Prepare approved cleaning solution at the defined concentration and contact time. Clean internal surfaces and removable parts.
5.4	Final rinse	Rinse with the approved final-rinse water quality until cleaning-agent residue is controlled according to the validated method.
5.5	Visual inspection	Inspect accessible product-contact surfaces under adequate lighting. No visible residue or foreign matter is permitted.
5.6	Dry / protect	Dry or drain as defined and protect the equipment from recontamination.
5.7	Document and status	Complete the cleaning record and apply the approved clean-status identification.

6. Release criteria

- Cleaning record complete and legible.
- Visual inspection acceptable.
- Required analytical / rinse / swab result acceptable where the validated procedure requires testing.
- No open technical defect affecting product-contact cleanliness.
- Any deviation assessed before release.

7. Records

- Equipment cleaning record
- Cleaning-agent preparation record where applicable
- Visual-inspection confirmation
- Analytical / swab / rinse result where applicable
- Deviation or maintenance record if required

8. Key drafting principle

A useful GMP SOP should make responsibilities, sequence, controls, records and exceptions explicit. It should not hide critical controls inside narrative text or rely on undefined phrases such as “clean thoroughly.”